CHAPTER TWO:

THE RED MENACE

Although *Captain America: The First Avenger* is primarily set during World War II, the filmmakers at Marvel Studios were quick to add a new twist to the concept of a period piece. Said studio head Kevin Feige, "Is this the authentic World War II period that you see on the History Channel? No, this is World War II of the Marvel Universe, where super-soldier programs are going on — where an organization called Hydra run by the Red Skull is tapping into these incredible sources of power, creating these vehicles and these weapons far beyond anything that we've seen before."

Said Co-Producer Stephen Broussard, "What's the Marvel version of that World War? What are the vehicles like? How do these powers clash in a way that's befitting of the time and of the character? So we're always looking for new and interesting ways to take existing bits of history and turn it on its ear."

And in that new past that never was, the biggest threat to world security wasn't the Nazi party, but an offshoot called Hydra — led by Captain America's most notorious villain, Johann Schmidt, the infamous Red Skull.